

2 Subject content and assessment information

The Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE in Spanish (9-1) allows students to develop their ability to communicate with Spanish native speakers in both speech and writing. They will study across a variety of contexts relevant to their age and interests and will also develop a greater awareness of culture of Spanish-speaking communities and countries. These contexts are listed under *Themes and topics* on pages 7 and 8.

Students will need to develop and use their knowledge and understanding of Spanish grammar progressively through their course of study. Grammar requirements are contained in the grammar list (see *Appendix 2: Grammar list*).

To help students build on their range of vocabulary, a list is provided of words that students are expected to use and understand (see *Appendix 3: Vocabulary list*). These lists are not exhaustive but are intended as a guide; students at both tiers will be required to understand and respond to familiar words (appropriate to the tier) that are not on the lists.

Subject aims and learning objectives

The aims and objectives of this qualification are to enable students to:

- develop their ability to communicate confidently and coherently with native speakers in speech and writing, conveying what they want to say with increasing accuracy
- express and develop thoughts and ideas spontaneously and fluently
- listen to and understand clearly articulated, standard speech at near normal speed
- deepen their knowledge about how language works and enrich their vocabulary in order for them to increase their independent use and understanding of extended language in a wide range of contexts
- acquire new knowledge, skills and ways of thinking through the ability to understand and respond to a rich range of authentic spoken and written material, adapted and abridged, as appropriate, including literary texts
- develop awareness and understanding of the culture and identity of the countries and communities where the language is spoken
- be encouraged to make appropriate links to other areas of the curriculum to enable bilingual and deeper learning, where the language may become a medium for constructing and applying knowledge
- develop language-learning skills both for immediate use and to prepare them for further language study and use in school, higher education or employment
- develop language strategies, including repair strategies.

Themes and topics

Questions across all four language skills are set in common contexts, addressing a range of relevant contemporary and cultural themes. They are organised into five themes, each broken down into topics and sub-topics.

The five themes are:

- Identity and culture
- Local area, holiday and travel
- School
- Future aspirations, study and work
- International and global dimension.

All themes and topics must be studied in the context of both the students' home country and that of countries and communities where Spanish is spoken.

For listening and reading assessments, the majority of contexts are based on the culture and countries where the assessed language is spoken. Students may also refer to the culture of the assessed language country/countries or communities in the speaking and writing papers. It is, therefore, important that students are exposed to materials relating to Spanish-speaking countries throughout the course.

Each topic has been highlighted in **bold**.

All topics must be studied in the context of both the students' home country and that of countries and communities where Spanish is spoken.

Theme: Identity and culture

- **Who am I?**: relationships; when I was younger; what my friends and family are like; what makes a good friend; interests; socialising with friends and family; role models
- **Daily life**: customs and everyday life; food and drink; shopping; social media and technology (use of, advantages and disadvantages)
- **Cultural life**: celebrations and festivals; reading; music; sport; film and television

Theme: Local area, holiday and travel

- **Holidays**: preferences; experiences; and destinations
- **Travel and tourist transactions**: travel and accommodation; asking for help and dealing with problems; directions; eating out; shopping
- **Town, region and country**: weather; places to see; things to do

Theme: School

- **What school is like**: school types; school day; subjects; rules and pressures; celebrating success
- **School activities**: school trips; events; exchanges

Theme: Future aspirations, study and work

- **Using languages beyond the classroom**: forming relationships; travel; employment
- **Ambitions**: further study; volunteering; training
- **Work**: jobs; careers; professions

Theme: International and global dimension

- **Bringing the world together**: sports events; music events; campaigns and good causes
- **Environmental issues**: being 'green'; access to natural resources

Paper 1: Listening and understanding in Spanish

Content

Students are assessed on their understanding of standard spoken Spanish in a variety of scenarios.

Students will need to:

- identify the overall message, key points, details and opinions
- deduce meaning from a variety of spoken texts
- recognise the relationship between past, present and future events
- recognise and respond to key information, important themes and ideas in spoken text, including authentic sources, adapted and abridged, as appropriate
- be able to answer questions, extract information, evaluate and draw conclusions.

This paper draws on vocabulary and structures across all the themes (outlined on pages 7–8).

Students are presented with recorded scenarios involving one or more speakers in public and social settings. Recordings include authentic sources addressing the themes. Recorded material features both male and female voices and represents different age groups.

Students should be given the opportunity to become accustomed to hearing the Spanish language spoken in a range of styles and registers.

Recordings for individual questions within the assessment vary in length, including both short and longer spoken passages, using both familiar language and, where appropriate, more complex language and abstract material, as appropriate to the tier.

To prepare students adequately for this assessment, teachers should present and exploit a range of vocabulary relevant to each theme listed and build on the Key Stage 3 Programme of Study, where appropriate.

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is out of 50 marks.
- Students must be allocated five minutes in which to read through the paper before the first extract of the recording starts. This gives students an opportunity to familiarise themselves with the length and the layout of the paper and to read the questions before hearing the first extract.
- Students will listen to the recording featuring Spanish-language speakers who will speak at a rate appropriate to the expected level of student understanding.
- Each passage is recorded twice, with pauses following the second hearing to allow each student sufficient time to write or note their response to each question (or part of a question) and to read the next question before the related extract is played.
- Recordings will be issued as audio files via our Secure Download Service (SDS) prior to the exam.
- Each question is set in a context drawn from the topics. The assessment tasks will feature general content that is familiar and accessible to all students.
- Students must answer all questions in both sections.
- *Foundation tier*
 - The assessment is 35 minutes, including 5 minutes' reading time.
 - Section A contains 12 questions set in English. Question types will comprise both multiple-response and short-answer open response questions. The instructions to students are in English.
 - Section B contains two questions set in Spanish. Question types comprise of multiple-response questions. The instructions to students are in Spanish.
- *Higher tier*
 - The assessment is 45 minutes, including 5 minutes' reading time.
 - Section A contains two questions set in Spanish. Question types comprise of multiple-response questions. The instructions to students are in Spanish.
 - Section B contains eight questions set in English. Question types comprise of both multiple-response and short-answer open response questions. The instructions to students are in English.
- Four of the questions will be common to both tiers.
- For both tiers, there is no requirement for students to produce written responses in Spanish.
- The use of dictionaries is not permitted.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Spanish Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.